

LI, JIAYI

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EDUCATION

University of Nottingham Ningbo China

Bachelor of Engineering (Honors) in Product Design and Manufacture

- Cumulative GPA: 3.8/4.0 (Scholaro GPA calculator), First-class Honors Degree

Ningbo, China

09/2022 – 06/2026

University of Washington, Seattle

Master in Human Centered Design & Engineering

Seattle, America

09/2026 – 06/2028

DESIGN AWARDS

Bronze in Conceptual Products / Toys & Games, International Design Awards (IDA)

12/2025

<https://www.idesignawards.com/winners/zoom.php?eid=9-63296-25&count=0&mode>

- HolaMind is an AI communication companion for teens that uses a prism-based pseudo-holographic display. Designed as a private “emotional safe space,” it helps adolescents recognize, express, and regulate their feelings. Through conversations with the product, HolaMind analyzes the user’s mood and renders a dynamic 2D avatar or pet, which the triangular prism transforms into a 3D-like image—enabling lifelike, face-to-face interaction and feedback

Bronze Award in the Inclusive Sports Product Design Hack 2024-25

08/2025

<https://www.lboro.ac.uk/schools/design-creative-arts/inclusive-sports-product-design/previous-winners/rainbow>

- The “Rainbow,” an inclusive product to support the Motor Activities Training Programme for kids with motor coordination challenges

First Prize in 2024-25 Loctek Innovation and Entrepreneurship Fund

06/2025

- Co Chair is a novel design of chair that is not only adjustable to fit different physical scenarios at home-it also creates opportunities for emotional bonding and behavioral learning. By allowing the child to sit at a height where they can observe their caregiver (e.g. in the kitchen), the chair encourages participation through observation. It relieves the caregiver from having to constantly hold the child, while supporting early-stage cognitive development through mimicking and emotional security

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

High-Rise Firefighter Tracking, Design Competition | Advisor: Prof. Jiang Wu

08/2025 – 04/2026

- This wearable device for firefighters was developed in collaboration with the Computer Science department. In high-rise fire scenarios, wearing this equipment enables rapid acquisition of firefighters’ 2D movement trajectories and current position. By tracking their paths, it reveals the building’s approximate layout, reduces redundant search-and-rescue efforts, and provides clearer routes for subsequent support crews, all of which help enhance high-rise rescue efficiency.
- Supported the development team by designing the prototype with a particular focus on aesthetic, functional, and CMF design, addressing performance requirements such as quick donning and device replacement across various scenarios

Immersive VR Exploration of Historical Design Movements | Advisor: Prof. Amarpeet Gill

02/2025 – 06/2025

- Collected user data for research preparation, designed questionnaires with tailored task-based testing
- Assisted in designing stages in the VR educational gaming experience to optimize user experience
- Conducted data analysis, user experience research and data visualization using SPSS

VR Design History – Time of Bauhaus | Advisor: Prof. Amarpeet Gill

02/2024 – 08/2024

- Developed a VR platform that time-travels its users to the time of Bauhaus – school of design, architecture, and applied arts that existed in Germany from 1919 to 1933 – allowing them to be fully immersed in the design culture and learn about renowned figures and philosophies of that time.
- Investigated how color, UI layout, and interaction methods affect reading efficiency and comprehension in VR environments, with findings applied to optimize information presentation in virtual educational settings
- Contributed to compiling a research paper as a co-author, the paper discusses the UI and experience design in the VR environment, such as reading interface, interface layout, color, and reading experience in virtual reality

FURP The Gamelab | Advisor: Prof. Amarpeet Gill

06/2024 – 08/2024

- Completed the entire workflow from game mechanic design and 3D modeling to interactive logic implementation
- Assisted in developing educational games using Unity3D and C#, and designed task feedback mechanisms based on educational objectives to enhance learning engagement and immersion

INTERNSHIP

VML (WPP Group)

Shanghai, China

Digital User Experience Design Intern

02/2026 – 06/2026

- Designed app, web, and campaign pages for airport and e-commerce projects, creating user flows, prototypes, and visual solutions to meet user and business needs.
- Contributed to launched projects including the Changi Airport app and Air New Zealand website, focusing on information architecture, UI design, and user journeys.
- Optimized UI and purchase journeys for JD and Douyin live-stream interfaces during the Fonterra Mead Johnson bid project.
- Integrated AI tools into daily design workflows, using Figma Make for rapid prototyping and Cursor to support front-end implementation.

Ningbo Puzhi Future Robotics Co., Ltd.

Ningbo, China

Industrial Design Intern

06/2025 – 08/2025

- Contributed to entire industrial design for the company's next-generation robotic products, including appearance design, CMF design, and new process development and validation
- Utilized Rhino and 3ds Max to model and render the outlook of a humanoid robot, used Procreate to illustrate inspirations
- Collaborated closely with R&D and engineering teams to ensure manufacturability of design solutions, following up with the entire product lifecycle from design to production
- Planned and executed comprehensive poster design and product marketing brochures solutions encompassing visual style positioning, information architecture, and typography optimization

Meanew Design

Ningbo, China

Product Design Intern

06/2023 – 08/2023

- Participated in full-cycle product design for home appliances and maternal-infant products, from user needs research to concept sketching, 3D modeling, and final presentation of solutions
- Assisted in optimizing the appearance and structural design of multiple products
- Employed design thinking methodologies for competitive analysis and user research, compiled market trend reports to support design decisions for project teams, and participated in brainstorming sessions and creative workshops

ACTIVITIES

UNNC Faculty of Science and Engineering Student Union | Liaison Specialist

09/2022 – 06/2023

- Assisted in hosting corporate career fair with Philips, led Geely Auto's campus recruitment event

- Secured funding and gift vouchers from off-campus sponsors (e.g., restaurants, apparel stores, educational institutions), and participated in planning the campus commercial pet maker competition

SKILLS

SolidWorks, Rhino, Blender, Keyshot, Unity3D, C#, Arduino, Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Generative AI tools